

Houthis Learn
To Make Arms
On Their Own

Relying Less on Tehran,
and Employing A.I.

By NICHOLAS KULISH

The popular image of Yemen’s Houthi rebels is of men on the backs of pickup trucks, firing AK-47s into the desert air.

Yet the group has launched long-range missile strikes at Israel, more than a thousand miles away. The Houthis prey on ship traffic in the Red Sea with naval drones. On Wednesday, the group said it had downed a Saudi fighter jet over Yemen using a locally made missile. Saudi Arabia said the Houthis also had sent a drone toward Mecca, which was shot down before reaching the city. [Page A9.]

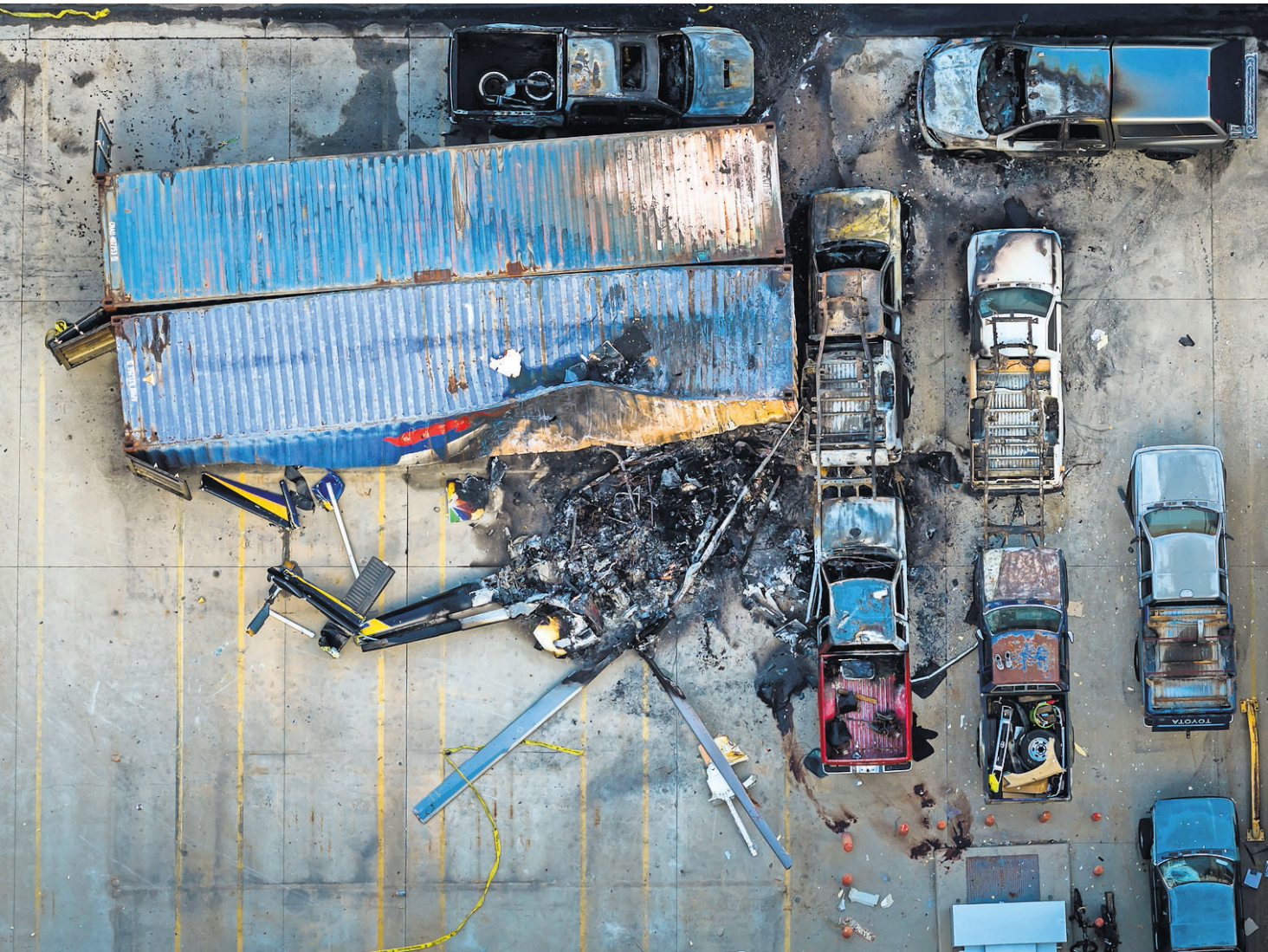
And evidence points to the Houthis’ growing ambition to use artificial intelligence and other means to produce more advanced weaponry themselves, making them less reliant on their sponsors in Iran.

Though they are backed by Iran, for months the Houthis remained on the sidelines of this year’s fighting in the region. That ended in July, when they declared a maritime blockade on Saudi Arabia. Since then, they have marched south, seizing the historic port city of Mokha last week while capturing islands near the narrow strait known as the Bab al-Mandab, tightening the group’s grip on the choke point at the southern end of the Red Sea.

“They use every opportunity to build their capability, to test their capability, such that they are now the most lethal nonstate actor in the entire Middle East,” said Timothy A. Lenderking, the former U.S. special envoy for Yemen, speaking at a Middle East Institute forum on Friday.

A report by Anthropic last week

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ETHAN SWOPE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A news helicopter crashed in Los Angeles on Tuesday while covering a fatal bus collision. A colleague described “the day we all dread.”

In a City of Aerial Reporting, a Crash Compounds a Story’s Sorrow

By SHAWN HUBLER

LOS ANGELES — The collision of the bus and the S.U.V. had been big, even by Los Angeles eye-in-the-sky standards. Desmond Shaw was stunned by its force.

Mr. Shaw, a veteran helicopter reporter, had gazed at the wreck from above, transfixed. His aircraft was one in a swarm hovering high over the San Fernando Valley on Tuesday. The transit vehicle had been bashed like a toy, the S.U.V. gutting its midsection. The

authorities were saying people were dead.

Mr. Shaw had been back at work less than a week after taking a leave prompted by the deaths of both parents, and he had been thinking lately about mortality. The crash was eerie for him, and he was glad to be done with the story.

But shortly after he and his pilot flew away, the newsroom called back: An aircraft appeared to have gone down near the scene of the bus crash.

5 Dead in L.A. Bus and
Chopper Accidents

Mr. Shaw, 45, who works for a CBS affiliate, thought of his fellow reporters aloft — colleagues for whom the air was their office.

“As soon as we got there and saw the fireball and the rotor blades, we knew what it was,” he said, speaking in an interview from his car early Wednesday. “It

was the day we all dread.”

The back-to-back bus and helicopter crashes killed at least five people and strewn blackened wreckage in the Chatsworth neighborhood of Los Angeles, starting shortly after 5 p.m. on Tuesday.

First, the S.U.V. broadsided a Los Angeles Metro bus, killing at least two people and critically injuring others. The driver has been charged with murder, the police said.

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U.K.’s Storks Are Back. Or Are They Trespassers?

By LEO SANDS

DIAL POST, England — The noisy throng of birds beat their wings and hopped up and down in their pen. These three-month-old white storks, fueled by a generous morning’s feed, were ready for takeoff.

As a keeper twisted open the gate of the pen, a dedicated crowd of bird watchers in stork-themed shirts held its collective breath from several hundred feet away. The sight of a juvenile stork on its first flight is not to be missed.

The lanky bird, fabled in European folklore as a bringer of life, is now a permanent addition to Britain’s skies. It is also a surprisingly contentious one.

To the conservationists behind the yearslong effort to establish a population, the storks’ introduction restores a species that was presumed to have been wiped out in Britain some 600 years ago. To some more skeptical naturalists, it is a misguided act that introduces a bird that had never made Britain its home.

The White Stork Project, as the effort is known, has so far established a colony of some 100 birds at Knepp, a 3,500-acre former dairy farm in West Sussex.

Over two decades, the environment has done most of the reclamation there unaided as part of a wider “rewilding” effort that lets natural processes govern the landscape. But Isabella Tree, the conservationist who co-owns Knepp, is giving it something of a push with the storks.

Unlike other birds that could strike out and breed from just one couple, storks are a sociable species and are more likely to survive in a colony, she said.

To build that colony, conserva-



HANNAH REYES MORALES FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A nesting white stork at the Knepp conservation area in England.

tionists have released captive-bred storks at Knepp every summer for the past eight years. The effort is working: Some 40 nests silhouette the landscape’s oak canopies.

This year’s batch of fledglings was bred at a zoo from birds that

had crashed into electrical pylons in Poland and became flightless. After mingling with the colony’s existing population of wild-hatched chicks, the juveniles are embarking on a thousand-mile seasonal migration to northern

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Jury Scrutiny May Complicate
Prospects for New Clancy Trial

By JENNA RUSSELL and NICHOLAS BOGEL-BURROUGHS

PLYMOUTH, Mass. — When several jurors from the murder trial of Lindsay Clancy spoke publicly last week about their deliberations, they probably did not imagine what would follow: Deep dives into their social media histories. Hateful memes depicting the women among them as crones. And excavation of two jurors’ past legal problems — none of which would have disqualified them from serving.

With a retrial of Ms. Clancy still possible, the intense scrutiny of the jurors whose deadlock led to a mistrial could complicate attempts to seat a new jury, from a pool of candidates who now have reason to fear a similar backlash.

The prosecutor in the case, Timothy J. Cruz, has not said whether he intends to retry Ms. Clancy, 36, for the strangling deaths of her three children in



JOSEPH PREZIOSO/A.P. — GETTY IMAGES

Timothy J. Cruz, the prosecutor, faces a decision on a retrial.

January 2023. She has admitted to killing Cora, 5; Dawson, 3; and Callan, 8 months. But according to the defense, she was experiencing postpartum psychosis at the time.

As Mr. Cruz weighs his next step, Ms. Clancy’s lawyer, Kevin Reddington, could try to argue that the lone holdout juror would

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World Starts Seeing U.S. as a Shaky Investment

By ALAN RAPPEPORT

WASHINGTON — Global investors are balking at U.S. bonds. Talk of the dollar’s dwindling power is getting louder. Foreign governments are hauling their gold out of American vaults.

Almost two years into President Trump’s second term, the world economy is increasingly looking for ways to distance itself from America. Concerns about a \$40 trillion debt burden, the excessive use of sanctions to solve

Jitters Over Rising Debt
and Use of Sanctions

foreign policy problems and Mr. Trump’s penchant for pushing the limits of the rule of law are raising questions about the appeal of the United States as a haven for global investment.

Despite pledges by foreign companies and nations to invest in the United States — in many

cases to curry favor with the White House — capital is starting to seek alternative destinations.

“Geopolitical factors and U.S. weaponization of the dollar through financial sanctions are causing central banks and other official investors to attempt to diversify away from dollar assets,” said Eswar Prasad, the former head of the International Monetary Fund’s China division.

The United States is not yet an investment pariah. Private in-

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INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Warning for Mountain Regions

Nepal’s landslide began in the bedrock, an analysis suggests. As glaciers retreat, instabilities are rising. PAGE A7

No Cliffhanger in Russia Vote

The parliamentary election is a safe bet, but Russians fear military and economic uncertainty afterward. PAGE A4

NATIONAL A11-19

Distrust Is Part of Poll Training

As thousands of observers are preparing for midterm elections, some are taught to expect bad behavior. PAGE A12

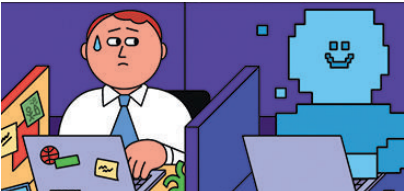
A ‘Cognitive Surrender’

An M.I.T. study reports that A.I. has upended education, confusing students and testing school leaders. PAGE A14

THURSDAY STYLES D1-8

Scenes of Structure and Slink

Both on and off the runway during New York Fashion Week, a dynamic emerged between sharper lines and slouchy silhouettes. PAGE D6



BUSINESS B1-6

A.I. Is Quietly Hitting Workers

Slower hiring in some sectors, especially for younger people, may be the result of artificial intelligence. PAGE B1

E.E.O.C. Says Cisco Failed Staff

The agency said that the tech giant likely allowed pro-Palestinian workers to be in a hostile environment. PAGE B1

ARTS C1-6

Sounds of a Dream House

The electronic musician Empress Of layered themes of instability and renewal on a new album threaded with her mother’s stories about their Altadena home lost in the 2025 wildfire. PAGE C1

Taking On ‘the First Desk’

In Season 6 of the Apple TV series “Slow Horses,” Kristin Scott Thomas gives a morally gray tinge to “Lady Di” Taverner, who claims the top job at Britain’s MI5 secret service. PAGE C1

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Jessica Grose PAGE A23



OBITUARIES A20-21

‘Tinker Creek’ Author

Annie Dillard’s Thoreau-like account of journeys in the woods was the first of many ruminations on life and nature, good and evil. She was 81. PAGE A20

